

Health Literacy

TC: C-1062 (TC)

[Link to Codes](#)

MCG Health
Transitions of Care
28th Edition

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Assessment

I would like to ask you some questions about how well you understand health information.

Q1. Patient: Do you need help understanding healthcare instructions from your doctor?

- Yes [B1] [P1]
- No
- Unknown [P1]

Q2. Patient: Do you need help understanding medicine information from the drug store?

- Yes [B1] [P1]
- No
- Unknown [P1]

Q3. Patient: Do you need help understanding instructions given by the hospital?

- Yes [B1] [P1]
- No
- Unknown [P1]

Q4. Patient: Can you fill out medical forms by yourself?

- Yes
- No [B1] [P1]
- Unknown [P1]

Plan of Care

Barriers

B1. Health literacy barrier

Problems

P1. Health literacy problems present

- **Goal:** Health literacy problems addressed and managed[A](1)(2)(3)(4)**NN**

- **Interventions:**

- **ASSIST:** Identifying patient's goal priorities, willingness/ability to achieve goals, and preferences for communication and follow-up
- **ASSIST:** Goal setting that is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and with target completion time (eg, short/long-term, prioritized)
- **ASSIST:** Understanding of health information. See Education: Patient, Family, and Caregiver [SR](#) and Teach Back Tool [SR](#).
- **ASSIST:** Understanding of health decisions (eg, treatment options, self-care)
- **ASSIST:** Creating written health information using materials designed for lower-literacy patients
- **ASSIST:** Identifying factors that can affect health literacy (eg, age, stress, time) and ways to manage factors
- **ASSIST:** Appointment scheduling with provider to evaluate self-care if health literacy issues could be affecting self-care
- **EDUCATE:** Health information in format best understood by patient (eg, handouts, videos, software programs)(5)
- **EDUCATE:** Health information in patient's native language(5)
- **COORDINATE:** Home care referral, if indicated

- **COORDINATE:** Community services referral, as needed
- **COORDINATE:** Follow-up contact to review health information understanding, referral status, and need for further assistance(6)(7)

Evidence Summary

Quality standards: Standards indicate that program content should address psychosocial issues (eg, literacy and health literacy) that may impede self-management. Programs should have a process for following up with patients on the status of referrals.(8)

Evidence: A review of 28 studies evaluating health literacy levels and chronic disease self-management found that low health literacy has a negative influence on medical management (especially adherence), patient-provider communication, and knowledge.(9)

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Footnotes

[A] Health literacy is the degree to which individuals have the capacity to obtain, process, and understand health information, and have the skills or services needed to make informed health decisions and take informed actions.(1)(10) Patients with inadequate health literacy are more frequently hospitalized, have decreased ability to manage conditions, and are less adherent to medication regimens. (11)(12) [A in Context Link 1]

Codes

ICD-10 Diagnosis: Z55.0, Z55.6, Z55.8, Z55.9

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